

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Unwanted Visitors ...



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about unlikely events or fairly certain conditions that will be fulfilled in present, past or future in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write a narrative paragraph.
- I can write about unlikely or impossible situations.
- I can write about two actions together.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever thought there was an intruder in your home? What happened?
- Do you believe in UFOs and aliens? Why or why not?

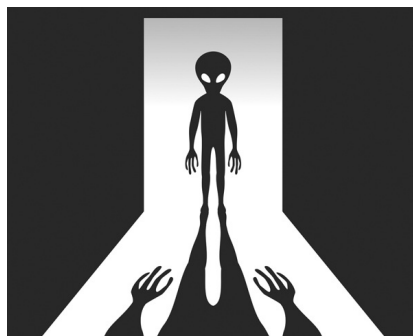




Let's Explore!

Caroline hears footsteps ... are their **intruders*** or ghosts in her home or is she imagining things?

* An "intruder" is someone who is in a place or situation where they are not wanted.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

The security and warmth of Caroline's bed masked a unidentified threat in her midst. The sun's rays were dazzling her half-open eyes. She enjoyed her slumber and had always avoided starting her day before 8 a.m. In fact, her boss had even advised her to rethink her late start times. If Caroline had known that her behavior might be leading to her dismissal she would have been more punctual. However, if Caroline knew what was about to take place in her apartment, she would leave and never come back. While she slowly leaned forward in her bed, rubbing her eyes, she started to hear footsteps coming from the attic. Convincing herself she was still half asleep, she opened the door to her bedroom and proceeded to make her way to the kitchen for a coffee.

Then, more sounds of footsteps on the stairs stopped Caroline in her tracks. "Hello?", she called out. There was no response. "I must be still dreaming. If I watched fewer horror flicks, I wouldn't be so jumpy", she muttered to herself as she kept on walking into the kitchen. While her coffee was brewing, Caroline looked out her back windows into the garden. Her eyes widened when she noticed a strange contraption in the middle of her lawn. The metal device appeared to have an antenna and odd markings. "If my neighbor's boy left that thing in my yard, I would be so angry. I forbid him to play in here", she thought to herself. Caroline started to feel like someone or something was watching her and was convinced that there was a burglar in the apartment. She whirled around in the vain hope of catching sight of an intruder. Frantic and trembling, she went straight for her cellphone on the counter and pushed speed dial.

Just as she was about to whisper the words, "I think there's someone in the apartment", she felt cold fingers tapping her shoulders. Paralyzed with fear, she was too frightened to move. If she had had her emotions under control, she would have seen the two tall, faceless figures in the doorway and another one pacing the living room. Suddenly, Caroline heard the faint words, "Take us home, earthling, take us home. I recommend you stay here with us today."





Let's Practice!

The author writes about unlikely or impossible situations.

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Identify the incorrect words. Write down the correct word to complete the sentence. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. If I watch fewer horror flicks, I wouldn't be so jumpy.
2. If Caroline had knows that her behavior might be leading to her dismissal, she would have been more punctual.
3. However, if Caroline knows what was about to take place in her apartment, she would leave and never come back.
4. If she had had her emotions under control, she would has seen the two tall, faceless figures in the doorway and another one pacing the living room.
5. If my neighbor's boy left that thing in my yard, I would been so angry.



Let's Practice!

Is there a thief in Caroline's apartment or someone else?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Select the correct answer. Fill in the blanks. Use: advised her to rethink, appeared to have, forbid him to play, proceeded to make her way, kept on walking, you staying.

1. I recommend _____ with us today.
2. I _____ in my yard.
3. She _____ into the kitchen.
4. In fact, her boss had even _____ her late start times.
5. Convinced herself she was still half asleep, she opened the door to her bedroom and _____ to the kitchen for a coffee.
6. The metal device _____ an antenna and odd markings.





Extension Activity

Now, let's take your narrative further.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Now, that you have written your narrative, it's now time to add another paragraph to your story. What happens next?
- Write a 150-170 word paragraph that follows the story you wrote.
- Include the same characters and setting.
- What happens next?
- Use sequencing words to connect ideas and to help the reader follow the story.
- Proofread your paragraph.
- Once completed, read your narrative aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a narrative paragraph about technology, exploration or UFOs.

☐ ☐

I include sequencing words in a narrative paragraph.

☐ ☐

I read my narrative paragraph aloud.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- paralyzed** (adjective): unable to function, act, or move
e.g. Paralyzed with fear, she was too frightened to move.
- to pace** (verb): to walk back and forth across the same space again and again especially because you are nervous
e.g. The other one was pacing in the living room.
- slumber** (noun): sleep
e.g. She enjoyed her slumber and had always avoided starting her day before 8 a.m.
- contraption** (noun): a piece of equipment or machinery that is unusual or strange
e.g. Her eyes widened when she noticed a strange contraption in the middle of her lawn.
- antenna** (noun): a device for sending or receiving signals
e.g. The metal device appeared to have an antenna and odd markings.
- to stop in one's tracks** (expression): to stop suddenly
e.g. Then, more sounds of footsteps on the stairs stopped Caroline in her tracks.
- vain** (adjective): having no success ; not producing a desired result
e.g. She whirled around in the vain hope of catching sight of an intruder.





Learning Points

Writing Tip: Unreal Conditional

The Unreal Conditional is used to write about what you generally would do in imaginary situations. The result of the condition is unclear and impossible to predict with certainty.

The Present Unreal Conditional is also called the second conditional.

You use the structure:

If... Simple Past, ... would+verb or Would+verb ... if ... Simple Past.

Example:

If Caroline knew that her behavior might be leading to her dismissal, she would be more punctual.

Caroline isn't aware that her behavior might be leading to her dismissal, therefore she isn't punctual.

You use the Unreal Conditional to refer to an unreal past condition that led to an impossible result. It is also called the third conditional. It is used to refer to an unreal condition that is in the past.

You use the structure:

If+ subject + Past Perfect, subject + Perfect Conditional

Example:

If she had known what was about to take place that day, she would have left earlier.

The condition of knowing what was going to happen is impossible. The result is that she didn't leave earlier.

Examples:

- *If I watched fewer horror flicks, I wouldn't be so jumpy.*
- *However, if Caroline knew what was about to take place in her apartment, she would leave and never come back.*
- *If Caroline had known that her behavior might be leading to her dismissal she would have been more punctual.*
- *If she had had her emotions under control, she would have seen the two tall, faceless figures in the doorway and another one pacing the living room.*
- *If my neighbor's boy left that thing in my yard, I would be so angry.*





Learning Points

Differences Between -ing and To-Infinitive

When you write about two actions linked together, you normally use two verbs. The first verb follows the rules of conjugation for the sentence, while the second verb can be a verb in the -ing form or to+Infinitive.

You can use two verbs to write about two connected actions. The main verb introduces the main action, and the second verb in the -ing form gives more information about that action.

Structure:

Subject + first verb + -ing form of the second verb / to+ Infinitive

Some verbs can be followed by either an -ing verb or to+Infinitive, like *like, love, hate, dislike, intend, dread, advise, recommend, regret ...*

The difference in meaning depends on the preceding verb.

Forget/Remember with to+Infinitive are looking forward into a future situation. With an -ing form they refer to a past action.

Advise/Recommend with to+Infinitive are followed by an object. With an -ing form there is no object.

Regret with to+Infinitive is a polite form of apology. With an -ing form it has the meaning of *If only this hadn't happened.*

Like/dislike/love/hate/can't stand/bear with to + Infinitive refer to habitual preferences.

go on with to + Infinitive suggests that an action happens after the initial verb. With an -ing form, the second verb is just a continuation of the first verb.

Look at some examples from the text:

Examples:

- *I recommend you stay with us today.*
- *I forbid him to play in my yard.*
- *She kept on walking into the kitchen.*
- *In fact, her boss had even advised her to rethink her late start times.*
- *Convincing herself she was still half asleep, she opened the door to her bedroom and proceeded to make her way to the kitchen for a coffee.*

